# LESSONS LEARNED REGISTER – FINAL

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| **Project Title:** | Mary's Consulting – New Company Website | **Date Prepared:** | Closeout snapshot – Dec 29, 2026 |

*Final closeout snapshot of the lessons learned register.* ***4 new lessons added during launch and closeout (LL-015 through LL-018);*** *14 prior lessons carried forward unchanged. At project closeout, the register will be transferred to the firm's organizational lessons-learned repository as an Organizational Process Asset for future projects.*

| ID | Category | Date | Trigger / Situation | Lesson Learned | Responsible Party | Comments |
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| LL-001 | Initiation | May 8, 2026 | Sponsor (Mary) signed the charter same-day after a single 30-minute review. | **Brief executive sponsors with a one-page summary before the formal review.** The executive summary sent 2 days early made Mary's review purely confirmatory. | Andrew (PM) | Pattern reused throughout. |
| LL-002 | Stakeholder | Jun 18, 2026 | Sales Lead initially Neutral; after early CRM-flow involvement, moved to Supportive. | **Engage downstream consumers (Sales) of project outputs before they become demanders.** | Andrew (PM) | Replicate for any project where Marketing delivers to Sales. |
| LL-003 | Requirements | Jul 2, 2026 | Consultant focus group revealed 3 Must-priority requirements not surfaced in interviews. | **Combine interviews with focus groups for user-research breadth.** | Andrew (PM) | Worth the extra week of elapsed time. |
| LL-004 | Design | Aug 7, 2026 | Sponsor design feedback came back faster than planned (2 days vs. 5). | **Have the designer present design reviews in person to the sponsor.** | Bill (UX) | Critical-path activity; saved 3 days. |
| LL-005 | Quality | Aug 26, 2026 | Pre-audit found only 4 Sev-3 contrast issues (prior projects averaged 20+). | **Build accessibility linting into CI from day one.** | Bob (Dev) / Bill (UX) | Make this firm-standard for all web projects. |
| LL-006 | Risk | Sep 8, 2026 | CRM API gap discovered during integration build. | **Schedule vendor technical-discovery calls BEFORE finalizing build estimates.** | Bob (Dev) | Add to firm's procurement-strategy template. |
| LL-007 | Stakeholder | Sep 14, 2026 | Consultant bio submission rate stuck at 38%. | **Distributed-stakeholder commitments need a named executive sponsor and tiered execution.** | Christine | Tiered launch should be the default approach. |
| LL-008 | Communication | Sep 14, 2026 | Editorial review queue bottlenecked on Christine. | **Identify single-point review bottlenecks early and partition the queue.** | Christine / Marketing Lead | Add to content-strategy template. |
| LL-009 | Procurement | Sep 16, 2026 | Frontend contractor delivered all milestones on or before due dates. | **Pre-paying 25% to lock contractor schedule is worth it for short engagements.** | Andrew (PM) | Negotiate this term in vendor SOWs by default. |
| LL-010 | Risk | Sep 16, 2026 | Sponsor-approval-delay risk (R-04) was originally rated Critical but never materialized. | **Pre-booking sponsor calendar slots and pre-briefing turns the highest sponsor-related risk into a non-event.** | Andrew (PM) | Cross-references LL-001 and LL-004. |
| LL-011 | Build | Sep 30, 2026 | Performance budget enforced in CI prevented two regressions. | **Performance budgets in CI are as valuable as automated tests.** | Bob (Dev) | Add to firm's CI/CD reference architecture. |

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| LL-012 | Planning | Oct 9, 2026 | Three-point estimates on build activities all came in within ±5% of expected duration. | **Three-point estimating works when the team has prior experience with the activity type.** | Andrew (PM) | For novel activities, use higher-uncertainty techniques. |
| LL-013 | Test | Nov 17, 2026 | UAT completed in 5 days vs. 7 planned, with zero Sev-1/2 findings. | **UAT goes faster when sponsors and SMEs are given written test scenarios in advance.** | Andrew (PM) | Saved 2 days on critical path. |
| LL-014 | Launch | Nov 24, 2026 | Production cutover on a Tuesday with zero incidents. | **Schedule production cutovers Tuesday–Thursday for full vendor-support availability.** | Bob (Dev) | Make this a firm-standard cutover policy. |
| LL-015 | Launch | Nov 26, 2026 | Day-2 post-launch monitoring caught a slow database query before users noticed; fix deployed in 90 minutes. | **Investing in monitoring/alerting BEFORE launch — not after — pays back immediately.** The hypercare 'war room' had real-time dashboards from day one. Without them, the slow query would likely have been reported by users hours later, eroding launch credibility. | Bob (Dev) / IT Operations | Make pre-launch monitoring config a release gate. |
| LL-016 | Closeout | Dec 8, 2026 | Hypercare period closed exactly on plan with zero Sev-1/2 incidents. | **A defined hypercare period (with explicit start, end, and exit criteria) makes it easier to transition to operations.** IT/Hosting Operations knew exactly when they were taking over; PM team knew exactly when they could release. No ambiguity, no friction. | Andrew (PM) | Document hypercare exit criteria in future PM Plans. |
| LL-017 | Closeout | Dec 15, 2026 | Marketing Lead and IT/Hosting Operations both signed the Transition document on first review — no rework cycles. | **Engage transition recipients DURING execution, not at handoff.** IT/Hosting Operations participated in architecture review (Aug), runbook drafting (Sep–Oct), and cutover rehearsal (Nov). By transition time, they already owned the operating model. | Andrew (PM) | Cross-references LL-002 (engage downstream stakeholders early). |
| LL-018 | Closeout | Dec 29, 2026 | Final benefits measurement delayed 90 days post-launch per Benefits Management Plan, preventing premature closeout judgment on lead-volume objective. | **Project closeout and benefits realization are different timelines.** The project closes Dec 29 but the 30%-MQL-lift target won't be measurable until Feb 2027. Plan for benefits measurement to outlive the project; identify the post-closeout owner up front. | Andrew (PM) / Marketing Lead | Marketing Lead owns the +90-day benefits report. |

**Final summary:** 18 lessons captured. **Recurring patterns elevated to firm-standard practices:** sponsor pre-briefing (LL-001, LL-004, LL-010); engage downstream stakeholders early (LL-002, LL-003, LL-017); build quality in from day one (LL-005, LL-011, LL-015); cutover discipline (LL-014, LL-015, LL-016). *Highlighted IDs (LL-015..LL-018) are new this period.* Register transferred to PMO repository Dec 29, 2026.